

These are the text changes we want to implement per section:

Our Mission

L.A.U.R.A. is dedicated to enhancing the quality of life for residents of South Central Los Angeles by empowering youth, supporting victim-survivors and families, and mobilizing the community through civic awareness, collaboration, and access to critical resources.

Our Vision

We envision a thriving, safe, and sustainable South Central Los Angeles—where families are supported through loss, youth are protected from violence, and communities are united through peace-driven action.

Our Story

L.A.U.R.A. was founded by **Adela Barajas**, a lifelong South Central Los Angeles resident, after the murder of her sister-in-law, Laura Sanchez, an innocent bystander killed in a drive-by shooting in 2007. Laura was a loving mother of four whose life was taken while parking her family van in front of her home.

This loss came less than a decade after Laura's mother, Irene Cruz, was also killed in a drive-by shooting.

Through grief came purpose. L.A.U.R.A. was created in Laura's memory to transform tragedy into action and ensure that no family in South Central Los Angeles has to face loss alone.

Our Strategy

Our comprehensive approach to community empowerment involves three key pillars that work together to create lasting positive change.

1. Safety Net for Victims of Crime & Survivors

No family should grieve alone. We've supported families through crisis and grief since 2007.

L.A.U.R.A. serves as a safety net for families impacted by homicide and violent crime, walking alongside loved ones through the most difficult moments of their lives.

We provide:

- Crisis response and emotional support for families of murder victims
- Victims of Crime assistance and referrals
- Guidance navigating legal, medical, and support systems
- Funeral and memorial fundraising assistance
- Candlelight vigils and community remembrance
- Support groups for healing and connection
- Assistance with transporting loved ones out of the country when needed

Why it matters:

Violence leaves lasting trauma. Compassionate, consistent support helps families heal and rebuild.

Help us support families in their darkest moments.

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2. Youth Leadership & Empowerment

Prevention starts with opportunity. Engaging youth in prevention and empowerment programs.

L.A.U.R.A. invests in young people by creating safe spaces, leadership opportunities, and pathways to success. Our youth programs focus on prevention, healing, and empowerment to help youth avoid gang involvement and reach their full potential.

Our youth programs provide:

- Leadership development and youth forums
- Violence prevention and early intervention support
- Peer-to-peer counseling and group therapy
- Youth employment readiness and job exposure
- College preparation and educational guidance
- Non-traditional experiences that expand horizons
- Family reunification and support services

Why it matters:

When youth feel supported, heard, and valued, cycles of violence are disrupted before they begin.

Invest in the next generation of leaders.

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3. Civic Engagement & Community Safety

Stronger communities create safer neighborhoods. We connect thousands of residents to vital resources each year.

L.A.U.R.A. works alongside residents, local leaders, and law enforcement to improve public safety and quality of life in South Central Los Angeles. Through civic engagement and collaboration, we help communities advocate for the resources they deserve.

This work includes:

- Building trust and communication between residents and law enforcement
- Facilitating community collaboration and neighborhood partnerships
- Supporting city service access and City Council engagement
- Community beautification and clean-up initiatives
- Advocacy for improved parks, infrastructure, and public spaces
- Supporting economic growth and attracting local businesses

Why it matters:

When residents are informed, engaged, and connected, communities become safer, healthier, and more resilient.

Support community-led safety and engagement efforts.

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Board of Directors